

Questions to Ask Your Home Inspector

Here are some questions you can ask when choosing a home inspector to decide if they are the right fit for you and the home you are inspecting.

Before the Inspection: Scope + Approach

- ☐ Are you a licensed home inspector in Texas?
- ☐ How many years of experience do you have?
- ☐ Do you get on the roof to inspect it, or do you inspect it from the ground or with a drone?
- ☐ Do you inspect the foundation and structure, including signs of movement or cracking?
- ☐ Are there any systems or areas you do not inspect that I should know about?
- ☐ Do you recommend additional inspections (sewer, structural engineer, mold, termites, etc.) based on the age or condition of the home?
- ☐ *If you are planning to receive Down Payment Assistance:* Do you know the inspection requirements for local down payment assistance programs, or will you work with me and my realtor to fulfill the requirements of any program I am participating in?
- ☐ Will you be able to provide your report within the option period?

Costs + Transparency

- ☐ What is the total cost of the inspection?
- ☐ Are there additional fees for older homes, larger homes, or add-on inspections?
- ☐ Are you independent from the seller and real estate agents?

During the Inspection: Participation + Communication

- ☐ Can I attend the inspection and ask questions?
- ☐ Will you point out major issues as you find them?
- ☐ How long will the inspection take?

The Inspection Report: What to Expect

- ☐ When will I receive the inspection report?
- ☐ Will the report clearly identify safety issues, major repairs, and routine maintenance items?
- ☐ Will photos be included to help me understand the issues?

After the Report: Next Steps

- ☐ Can you walk me through the report and explain what the findings mean?
- ☐ Which issues should I consider serious or expensive?
- ☐ Which issues are common for homes of this age?
- ☐ Are there repairs that may affect my ability to get a mortgage, insurance, or down payment assistance?